Our paper account, monthly report, 2026-10-16 close to 2026-10-28 close, from the lab's sealed nightly record

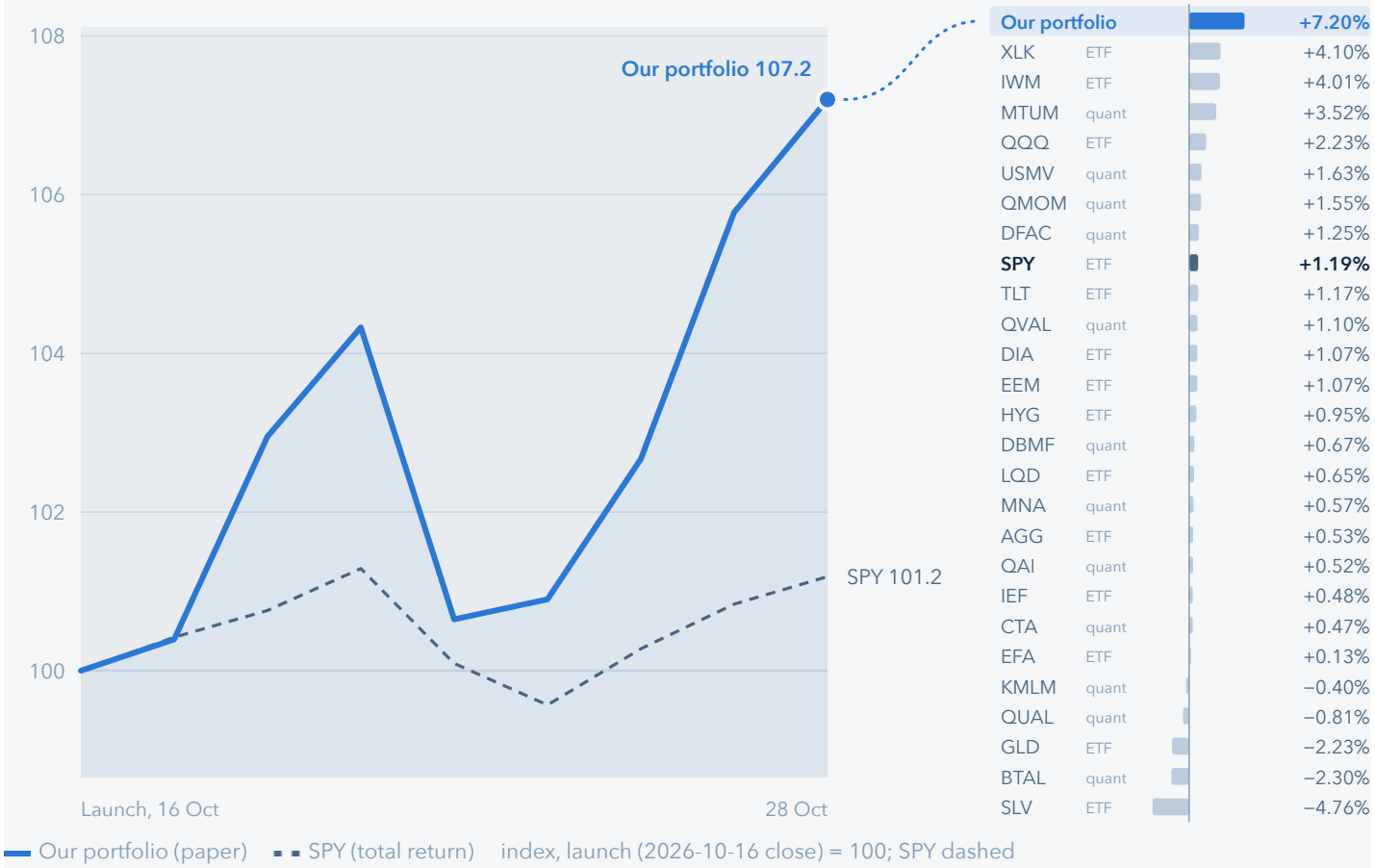
We are up 7.20% since launch.

SPY **+1.19%** over the same 8 sessions, so we lead by **+6.01 pts**.
Today we made **+1.34%**, SPY **+0.34%**.
This month (8 sessions from the 2026-10-16 close): we **+7.20%**, SPY **+1.19%**.
Drawdown now **0.00%**, worst **−3.53%** on 22 Oct; index 107.20.

> Paper trading (simulated money), not proven, hypothetical results, not investment advice. The account trades on a broker's paper engine, whose fills differ from real trading.

We count from launch, the **2026-10-16 close = 100**. The lab's nightly record starts earlier, at the 2026-10-08 close; our numbers are its account index divided by the value at launch. SPY is the benchmark: its total return. Returns are not annualised; 8 sessions are far too few to judge skill.

Full record from the 8 Oct close: we **+4.68%**, SPY **−0.21%**, above 26 of 26 funds. Launch is the 16 Oct close, and also the record's lowest close.



Our portfolio		**+7.20%**
XLK	ETF	+4.10%
IWM	ETF	+4.01%
MTUM	quant	+3.52%
QQQ	ETF	+2.23%
USMV	quant	+1.63%
QMOM	quant	+1.55%
DFAC	quant	+1.25%
SPY	ETF	**+1.19%**
TLT	ETF	+1.17%
QVAL	quant	+1.10%
DIA	ETF	+1.07%
EEM	ETF	+1.07%
HYG	ETF	+0.95%
DBMF	quant	+0.67%
LQD	ETF	+0.65%
MNA	quant	+0.57%
AGG	ETF	+0.53%
QAI	quant	+0.52%
IEF	ETF	+0.48%
CTA	quant	+0.47%
EFA	ETF	+0.13%
KMLM	quant	−0.40%
QUAL	quant	−0.81%
GLD	ETF	−2.23%
BTAL	quant	−2.30%
SLV	ETF	−4.76%



Against well-known ETFs and quant-style funds

Since launch (the 16 Oct close) we returned **+7.20%**, above **26 of 26** funds. SPY is the only benchmark; the others are context. The quant-style funds are listed funds that run the methods of well-known quant firms, as proxies of those styles.

Fund	Group	What	Since launch	We minus fund
XLK	ETF	US technology	+4.10%	+3.09 pts
IWM	ETF	Russell 2000	+4.01%	+3.19 pts
MTUM	Quant fund	Momentum factor (iShares MSCI USA)	+3.52%	+3.67 pts
QQQ	ETF	Nasdaq-100	+2.23%	+4.97 pts
USMV	Quant fund	Minimum volatility (iShares MSCI USA)	+1.63%	+5.57 pts
QMOM	Quant fund	Quant momentum, 50 stocks (Alpha Architect)	+1.55%	+5.65 pts
DFAC	Quant fund	Factor-tilted US equity (Dimensional)	+1.25%	+5.95 pts
SPY	ETF	S&P 500	+1.19%	+6.01 pts
TLT	ETF	US Treasuries 20y+	+1.17%	+6.02 pts
QVAL	Quant fund	Quant value, 50 stocks (Alpha Architect)	+1.10%	+6.10 pts
DIA	ETF	Dow Jones 30	+1.07%	+6.12 pts
EEM	ETF	Emerging markets	+1.07%	+6.13 pts
HYG	ETF	High-yield credit	+0.95%	+6.25 pts
DBMF	Quant fund	Managed futures: replicates the large CTA hedge funds (iMGP DBi)	+0.67%	+6.53 pts
LQD	ETF	Investment-grade credit	+0.65%	+6.55 pts
MNA	Quant fund	Merger arbitrage (IQ)	+0.57%	+6.63 pts
AGG	ETF	US aggregate bonds	+0.53%	+6.66 pts
QAI	Quant fund	Hedge fund replication, multi-strategy (IQ Hedge)	+0.52%	+6.68 pts
IEF	ETF	US Treasuries 7-10y	+0.48%	+6.72 pts
CTA	Quant fund	Managed futures (Simplify)	+0.47%	+6.73 pts
EFA	ETF	Developed ex-US	+0.13%	+7.07 pts
KMLM	Quant fund	Managed futures: trend index (KFA Mount Lucas)	−0.40%	+7.60 pts
QUAL	Quant fund	Quality factor (iShares MSCI USA)	−0.81%	+8.01 pts
GLD	ETF	Gold	−2.23%	+9.42 pts

Fund	Group	What	Since launch	We minus fund
BTAL	Quant fund	Market neutral: long low beta, short high beta (AGF)	−2.30%	+9.50 pts
SLV	ETF	Silver	−4.76%	+11.95 pts

Fund returns: daily closes adjusted for splits and dividends, read 2026-10-28 22:41 UTC, after the close; their SPY return equals ours.

Sessions

Date	We	SPY	Index	We since launch	SPY since launch	Drawdown	Seal (seq, hash)
2026-10-19	+0.40%	+0.42%	100.40	+0.40%	+0.42%	0.00%	22 `5e1916fc1a5e`
2026-10-20	+2.55%	+0.34%	102.95	+2.95%	+0.76%	0.00%	23 `4d4b4d139d36`
2026-10-21	+1.34%	+0.53%	104.33	+4.33%	+1.29%	0.00%	24 `d9ca34388ab9`
2026-10-22	−3.53%	−1.18%	100.65	+0.65%	+0.09%	−3.53%	25 `f3ecff81f6f1`
2026-10-23	+0.25%	−0.52%	100.90	+0.90%	−0.43%	−3.28%	26 `236c1c8eb9b6`
2026-10-26	+1.75%	+0.71%	102.67	+2.67%	+0.28%	−1.59%	27 `8faec400b174`
2026-10-27	+3.03%	+0.56%	105.78	+5.78%	+0.84%	0.00%	28 `bc5d8f550cde`
2026-10-28	+1.34%	+0.34%	107.20	+7.20%	+1.19%	0.00%	pending

Record seal of 2026-10-28: pending (the next nightly run seals it; hash of that day's record file now `e72d572c9fbc1bcebbbe12cf50eda05dab12ffb47131090ef9c304f74b240e55`). Latest seal: 2026-10-27, seq 28, hash `bc5d8f550cdea53c68622d6e5f6bc713109241da6a86eb22c4e03cc7ef91b1ab`.

The book at the 28 Oct close

80 names and cash 9.5% of the account; beta to SPY 1.66. We do not publish the names.

Stress period (the book replayed)	Book	SPY
March 2020 crash (SPY peak to trough)	−35.8%	−33.8%
2022 rate shock (SPY 2022 high to low)	−36.9%	−24.5%

What the book would have done in past market falls; not a forecast.

Context

The lab has run 36 strategy studies; 13 failed their pre-registered test, and failed results are kept. None has yet met the lab's bar for real money. Our rules are frozen before they run, and they are not proven. A paper record of a few weeks cannot separate skill from luck: at a Sharpe ratio of 0.5 a forward record needs well over a decade to reach t 2.

How to check this record

Each night the lab seals that day's record files in an append-only hash chain: each entry holds the hashes of the day's files and the hash of the entry before it. The hash printed for each date lets a reader later confirm that the past numbers did not change. A date is sealed by the nightly run of the next session, so the latest date shows pending.

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